that Anirudhya's skill lay in news gathering and not writing perfect copies. His copy would have to go through Bobb.

Bobb looked at Anirudhya's copy later in the day and said that Shekhar had already filed most of that information. 'He did that from Madras?' 'Yes, a journalist of Shekhar Gupta's repute can access information from anywhere,' came the response. 'See what else you can give me. By tonight.' Bobb went back to his printouts.

That night, Verma called and said something that could have far-reaching implications. Anirudhya telephoned Bobb and asked if he could come now to meet him.

'Tell me over the phone. You need not come to the office.'

'Law Minister Subramanian Swamy claimed at the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs meeting that he suspected the Tamil guerrilla outfit LTTE behind the assassination. But the R&AW chief G.S. Bajpai ruled out any involvement of the Tamil Tigers in the assassination.'

Bobb asked Anirudhya to come to the office and hung up. Swamy was a close confidant of the Prime Minister. The information was sensitive. The story was better discussed threadbare in person.

The first details of the *India Today* cover story were falling into place, with reporters sending their inputs from Madras, Colombo, London, New York, Singapore and New Delhi. Anirudhya was desperately trying to catch hold of Subramaniam Swamy, a politician known for making sensational—and often revealing—claims. Anirudhya had the luck to catch up with him in his car from his South Avenue residence to his party's parliamentary office.

Apparently, Swamy, on multiple occasions, had cautioned the Congress party about its inept handling of the Indo-Sri Lanka Accord. He claimed to have told a senior Congress leader from the south, known for her proximity to Rajiv Gandhi and Internal Security Minister P. Chidambaram, that the LTTE supremo Velupillai Prabhakaran would strike directly at the former Prime Minister. According to Swamy, Prabhakaran was upset with Rajiv